10 Missing out words; abbreviations

A

Missing out words is common in emails. It happens where the people know each other well and the context is informal, or when the email is written very quickly in a busy working day.

Match the sentences (a–j) to their descriptions (1–5) below.

a) (That's a) Good idea!
b) (I) Think your idea is great.
c) (Have you) Ever been there?
d) (It) Sounds like fun!
e) (I'll) Speak to you later.
f) (I) Hope you're well.
g) Just read (the) email about relocation.
h) (Are you) Coming with us on Friday for a drink?
i) (I am) Looking forward to seeing you.
j) (It's a) Pity we missed you yesterday.

1 The subject *I* can be left out, especially with verbs like *hope*, *think*, etc. ..b.. /.....
2 The words *I am* / *I have* / *I will* can be left out when they are followed by a main verb. ..... /.....
3 In a question, *Are you* / *Did you* / *Have you* can be left out. ..... /.....
4 The subject *That* or *It* can be left out, often with a form of *be* as well. ..... /..... /.....
5 The word *the* can be left out. .....

B

There are 17 places where words are missing in this email. Put back the missing words.

It was a
(Great evening, wasn't it! Really enjoyed the meal, and nice to see Mary and Roger again. Had a chance to speak to Lucy yet? Don't worry if you haven't, will be seeing her tomorrow.

About next week – film you suggested sounds great. Been talking to some colleagues at work about it. Tuesday might be difficult. Perhaps Wednesday better? Let me know.

Sometime soon we need to talk about holiday plans for next summer. Things are still a bit uncertain at work. Might be possible to take two weeks off in July, but can't be sure.

Going to see my parents at weekend – looking forward to it. They live in Chichester. Ever been there?

Anyway, got to go now. Hope you're well.

See you next week.

Before you check in the Answer key, here are the words you need:

Have you (×2)	I (×4)	I'll	I'm (×2)	I've (×2)	It	it was	It was
a	the (×2)	would be					

C

The abbreviations below are often found in writing. Match (1–4) with meanings (a–d).

1 ie (*id est*) .....
2 eg (*exempli gratia*) .....
3 NB (*nota bene*) .....
4 PS (*post script*) .....

a) I am going to give an example.
b) I am going to explain what I mean using different words.
c) I am adding some information at the end that I forgot.
d) I want you to give special attention to this next point.

D If emails are written very quickly you often find abbreviated forms. Techniques include:

1 using a letter or number to represent a sound (*cu = see you, thx = thanks*)
2 making a short form of a common word (*yr = your, wd = would, re = regarding* or *in relation to*)
3 missing out letters completely if the word is obvious (*recd = received, pls = please*)
4 writing the first letters of a well-known phrase (*asap = as soon as possible, Bw = Best wishes*).

Write out the following emails in full.

Email 1

Subject: Yr order ref no KD654
Re yr order recd today, we can't supply the quant u need right now. Pls confirm asap if a part-delivery wd be acceptable, with the rest to follow later. Rgds, Wei.

Subject: Your order reference number KD654

Email 2

Subject: Thx for yr msg
Re your msg left on my v/mail — yes, I'm free 4 lunch Wed next wk. Btw, gd news about yr job interview. Hv 2 work now. CU, Jane.

Subject:

Email 3

Subject: Tech Support
Sorry I missed yr call. Re tech support, on the website we hv a Knowledge Base and extensive list of FAQs. Shd find what you want there. But if you do need to spk to sb, you can call me during normal wkng hrs. Bw, Alan.

Subject: